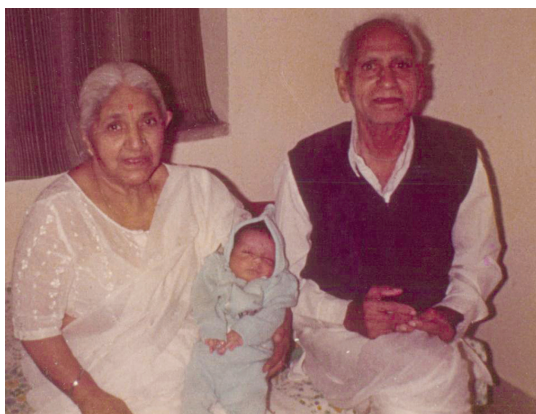




Amrit's parents with his son Akshay

elite of a city proved to be one of the biggest encouragements in the life of Amrit.

"I always felt like I was not a have among the haves. That formed my determination to do well in life. I wanted to become one of them as life progressed. My schoolmates made my determination strong to succeed in life," he explains.

Amrit's biggest inspiration is his father. He would spend hours preparing the finest of sweets to make sure that business was good, so he could afford good education for his children. The population of Udaipur, as Amrit shares, was only about 25,000 people back then. The competition between the sweet shops was cut-throat and anybody who compromised on quantity or quality immediately witnessed a dip in sales.

The financial condition of the family was so weak that Amrit's elder brother had to leave education and help his father at the sweets shop. It was Amrit's father who backed the decision of Amrit preparing for the IIT exams. Most of his other family members did not know about IIT and hence did not back him for taking the exam.

"He told me to prepare for the exams with complete focus and determination. He would tell me that even if I am not able to make it to IIT, I would always have a sweets shop to run and earn from," Amrit recalls. There were only two students who made it to IIT from Udaipur at that

time. How did Amrit learn that working hard is the key to success?

He answers, "I remember my father cycling 10 to 12 kilometres every day at 4am in the morning to get milk from a nearby village for our sweets shop. He would put milk containers on both sides of the bicycle. I took it from him to always work hard."

Amrit was so encouraged by his father that he would come back from school and

immediately finish homework and start reading for the next day. Amrit was found solving math more often than not. The amount of time that Amrit was spending on books can be gauged from the fact that his mother scolded him to stop studying as she believed that spending that amount of time would ruin his son's eyesight.

"I used to study in the light of earthen lamps before electricity came to our house. My mother would always become anxious as she saw me continuing to do math for hours in the light of the earthen lamp. The attitude of doing hard work came from my father," he says. Amrit was so good at studies his school principal gave him a double promotion and he was promoted to fourth standard straight from second standard.

First business lessons

Amrit, known to have a sharp brain when it comes to business, had his first business classes at his father's sweets shop. These business lessons not only included selling to end consumers but also manufacturing products to be sold. He would also sit on the counter at times and manage the

cash inflow. Amrit started helping his father at the shop when he was seven, and the first job his father gave him was that of sourcing ingredients used in preparing sweets. Any incident that he still remembers from those days?

"There was this time when I had lost money that my father had given to buy some ingredients. I was so scared that I didn't go to my shop and my father started searching for me. When he finally found me, he hugged me and told me not to worry as he saw me crying. Those were the golden days of life," recalls an emotional Manwani.

This incident, as he shares, was the one which taught him the opposite of what was taught in a lot of business schools. He got certain that day that people who are emotionally attached to their profession, and other people who work with them, are the ones that can accomplish anything.

"I was never fond of eating sweets. In fact, I also quit cooking a long time back. And I must tell you that I was a master at preparing sev namkeen at a very early age. I was also good at making rabdi, gulab jamuns, and kulfi. If my father were to listen to this statement today, he would twist my ear and tell me that I could have prepared sweets (at the shop)," he shares with a smile and eyes full of light. Amrit, who quit cooking a long time ago, never missed a chance to cook rabadi or prepare kulfi for his father. He also often cooked for his children when they were young.

Amrit found his slot when time came to select subjects for the ninth class and start focusing on them. "I was a good student but I also used to feel a little bit inferior in front of the other kids. There was a time when I

Facts about Amrit Manwani you do not know

1. Amrit Manwani's parents migrated to India from Pakistan during the partition
2. Amrit Manwani's sister was born on a railway platform
3. Amrit Manwani's father owned a sweet shop. Amrit knows how to prepare sweets like rabaddi, kulfi, jalebi, sev, gulab jamun, and more
4. Amrit Manwani met his wife at a job interview
5. Amrit Manwani had invested almost everything in Sahasra's semiconductor initiative